

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St.Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paranur



THE CLICKETY CLACK CONTINUES

Here are voices from the city that assert that though typewriting institutes have steadily dwindled in numbers, the manual typewriter still deserves a place under the sun, alongside the computer **P4**



SCREEN TIME OFF FOR SENIORS TOO

On August 15, two workshops seek to wean grown-ups off screens by teaching them a craft **P6**

Lakshmipuram crematorium awaits public use

Activists allege delay over trial run, while Corporation says maintenance arrangements have now been finalised



Tambaram Corporation's gasifier crematorium at Lakshmipuram in Chromepet. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

T. ARVIND

Nearly a year after its inauguration, Tambaram City Corporation's gasifier crematorium in Lakshmipuram, Chromepet, remains unopened for public use.

Residents and activists allege that the authorities have cited the need to conduct a trial run using an unclaimed body before commencing operations, resulting in the delay.

V. Santhanam, senior activist and founder of the People's Awareness Association, who has submitted multiple representations urging the Corporation to operationalise the facility, said the crematorium would benefit residents of Lakshmipuram as well as neighbouring localities such as Nagappa Nagar, New Colony and Umayalpuram.

"Most unclaimed bodies are handled by non-governmental organisations. To avoid further de-

lay, I wrote to senior doctors at government hospitals requesting that such bodies be handed over to the crematorium after completing the required police formalities," Santhanam said.

A senior Corporation official said the ₹2.5-crore gasifier crematorium, located in Ward 30 of Zone 1, was taken up during 2024-25 and was completed and handed over by the contractor in mid-February 2026. The site had earlier functioned as an open-air crematorium.

"There was already a temple dedicated to Harichandra and a water tank on the premises. The facility had to be designed without disturbing these structures," the official said.

The official added that maintenance of such crematoria is generally entrusted to a trust after due verification and in accordance with government norms. Since local residents had expressed interest in maintaining the facility, the Corporation waited for them to constitute a trust,

leading to the delay. As no trust was formed in accordance with the prescribed guidelines, the maintenance has now been entrusted to M.H.T. Engineering, which has experience in operating such facilities.

"However, if local residents form a trust that satisfies the prescribed norms, the Corporation is willing to hand over the maintenance to them," the official said.

Responding to the allegation, the official said the trial run had already been completed and that a permanent name board with details of the facility would be installed within a few days.

"Not only residents of Lakshmipuram, but people from neighbouring areas can also use the crematorium after submitting the required documents to the Corporation," the official said.

Residents and activists have urged the Corporation to throw open the facility for public use at the earliest and install clear signboards and contact details for the benefit of the public.

PLAN YOUR WEEK



Madras Day: a bird walk at Perumbakkam wetland

Madras Naturalists' Society (MNS) has planned various events for Madras Day Celebrations 2026. For residents from this part of the city, MNS is conducting a bird walk at the Perumbakkam wetland on August 18. The natural wetland and bird-watching site in Perumbakkam is said to have been an integral part of the larger Pallikaralai Marshland ecosystem and serves as an important seasonal habitat for many resident and migratory waterbirds.

Registrations for this walk will open on August 12. Children below 12 have to be accompanied by adults. Registrations is on first-come-first-serve basis, only via link <https://forms.gle/wo2aBdK4fVMsmkpZ6>.

An insect walk at Madhavaram Botanical Garden on August 14; and a shore walk at Nochikuppam on August 17 are a few others walks on the list.

If need help in conducting an event for Madras Day, WhatsApp 98410 49155

For more details about workshops, talks, contests and heritage walks happening as part of Madras Day, visit <https://themadrasday.in>

Events to address women's rights at Chitlapakkam Lake

Chitlapakkam Rising and PENN (Protection and Empowerment of Naari) are organising an awareness event 'Break The Silence' on August 15.

The event will showcase skits, dance, songs, and talks to address women's safety and rights, and will be attended by students

from schools and colleges in Chitlapakkam and Tambaram regions.

The event will begin at Chitlapakkam Lake amphitheatre at 5 p.m.

For details, contact Sunil Jayaram of Chitlapakkam Rising at 95001 22151.

Write to us about events happening in your neighbourhood to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in

Two causes rolled into one

Residents, students and civic activists urge action to curb drug abuse and restore waterbodies in Tambaram Corporation

T. ARVIND

Hundreds of residents, civic activists, students and women participated in an awareness rally against substance abuse and for the protection of lakes and other water bodies, organised by the Federation of Civic Residents' Welfare Associations (Zones 2 and 3, Tambaram Corporation) on August 2, 2026.

The rally was jointly organised with Parvathy Hospitals and flagged off by Dr. S. Muthukumar, founder of the hospital, near the sluice gates of Nanmangalam Lake.

According to M. Sreedhar, president of the Federation of Civic Residents' Welfare Associations (Zones 2 and 3), the rally covered nearly 6 km, beginning at 6 a.m., and wit-



nessed enthusiastic participation from residents, including senior citizens. Around 100 students from the Madras Institute of Technology (MIT) and S.C.S. Matriculation Higher Secondary School also took part.

Participants carried placards bearing slogans such as "Reject Drugs, Win Tomorrow" and "If Lakes Survive, Humans Survive", while raising awareness on the twin themes of substance abuse prevention and water body conservation.



Residents and students participate in the rally.

"Our route was planned to pass through areas where vulnerable youth are more likely to fall prey to substance abuse. The participation of nearly 500 people despite the early morning hours reflects the priority residents and youngsters attach to these issues," Sreedhar said.

Inspector Sivakumar of the Chitlapakkam Police Station presided over the rally, which concluded near Chitlapakkam Lake. At the valedictory event, an MIT student administered a pledge against substance abuse, which was repeated by the participants.

Thanking the police and Parvathy Hospitals for supporting the event, the Federation urged the Tambaram Corporation to honour its assurances on protecting local water bodies.

Sreedhar said the Federation had submitted multiple representations seeking restoration of Nanmangalam Lake, Putheri Lake, Sembakkam Lake, Pallavaram Periya Eri, Nemilichery Lake and Veeraghavan Lake. "Though the officials receiving our petitions keep changing, the issue remains unresolved and there has been little visible progress on the ground," he said.

Activists also appealed to the police and the public to work together to curb substance abuse, which they said was increasingly affecting even school students.

Urban forest in Vengadamangalam



The Environmentalist Foundation of India (EFI), in coordination with Hexaware Technologies and Chengalpattu District Collectorate, has cultivated an urban forest, 'Vengai Vanam'.

The forest is located in the village of Vengadamangalam.

Arun Krishnamurthy, founder of EFI, says that the land was marked by invasive weeds and non-biodegradable waste. "We fenced the area, removed waste and weeded. We ensured that native tree saplings weren't disturbed during the weeding exercise."

A total of 5,000 native tree saplings, fruit, nectar, and berry-bearing trees were planted.

The fences were put up over an area of 1,200 feet to protect the young saplings from cattle, human disturbance, trash dumping, and encroachments, adds Arun.

Water raised from the Panchayat's well is used for irrigation. A network of 11 pipelines (11 water outlet valves) has been established across the plantation site, and a 200-meter hose pipe is used for regular irrigation to maintain optimum soil moisture and support the healthy growth of the saplings, the environmentalist pointed out.

Various volunteer activities such as cleanups, tree planting, and environmental programmes were conducted to raise awareness in the surrounding community. On weekends, volunteers and school and college students come to care for the saplings, remove litter, and contribute to conservation efforts.

The growing urban forest is restoring biodiversity, recharging groundwater, and rebuilding ecological balance.



Sprawling Guduvancherry Eri yet to have lighting

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Residents of Guduvancherry have requested Water Resources Department to provide power connection for the lighting poles on the bunds of Guduvancherry Eri.

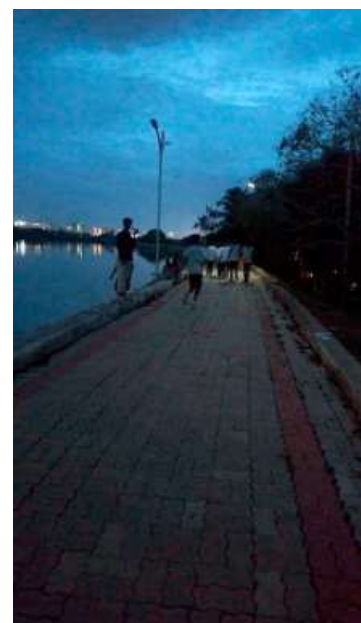
Some months ago, between Madambakkam Main Road and the rail overbridge at Guduvancherry railway station, WRD had desilted a portion of the lake, formed bunds, and constructed a walkway with revetment walls.

Around 20 posts have been installed, but the power connection

is yet to be provided.

A number of people use the walkers' path in the evenings and during weekends. It would be good if power is supplied as it would deter any antisocial activities from happening, says P. Thirumalai, a resident.

Residents also want other issues to be attended. At certain sections, the slabs in the walkers' path are uneven and missing. Other demands include installing benches and canopies for bird-watching and placing trash bins to prevent visitors from littering the lake area.



Road work does more damage to street in Chitlapakkam

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Thirumagal Nagar Second Street in Chitlapakkam has witnessed changes in the last one month but those changes are of little help to residents. More than a month ago, Tambaram City Municipal Corporation had dug up the stretch to lay a new concrete road. While digging the road, the drinking water pipelines got damaged. After milling the stretch, the pipes were repaired, and the road was re-laid.

But, motorists, including drivers operating heavy vehicles started taking the stretch and Third Street, causing damage to the road surface. Again, the road was re-laid, but the road has suffered cuts at points. Near Sreevatsa Viswanathan Vivekananda Vidyalaya Senior Secondary School in Chitlapak-



kam, the road milling work has not been done properly. Stones cover the un-laid portion. The damaged concrete surface is visible.

N. Balu, a resident, said, "The situation would not have occurred if barricades were placed to keep vehicular traffic at bay.

V. Thiruvalluvan, a resident, says, "The road was in a good condition and there was no need for re-laying it. Now, it is in a mess after

the exercise. If work is carried out, it should be completed in a timely manner. The civic body should depute personnel to ensure that quality work is carried out in accordance with the technical specifications. In the days to come, the civic body plans to construct the Underground Drainage System network, and the road will be dug again. The exercise is a waste of money and is causing inconvenience to residents and schoolchildren."

When a work is carried out, the civic body should display the project details including the start and finish periods, length of the road and contractor details and the corporation official responsible for supervision."

Thirumagal Nagar Second Street is yet to be laid; and (left) a section that is badly bruised.



RWA takes issue with Panchayat Raj

Nesamani Nagar Residents' Welfare Association (NNRWA) in Perumbakkam has requested the Rural Development and the Panchayat Raj Department, Government of Tamil Nadu, to address a long-pending issue in the region.

For more than a decade, around 100 streets in the region haven't been black-topped, citing a lack of sufficient funds (as stated by Perumbakkam Village Panchayat).

N. K. Raja, president of NNRWA, says, "The road is pitted with potholes, uneven surfaces, and marked by stones, inconveniencing pedestrians and vehicle users. We have represented this issue many times to CM Cell, Perumbakkam Village Panchayat, Saint Thomas Mount Panchayat Union and former Kancheepuram District Collector, and Chengalpattu District Collectorate."

The association has requested that the Department allocate funds to the area at the earliest to lay the roads.

Text: T.S. Atul Swaminathan

Exnora restores Keezhkattalai lake

Exnora International Foundation, in association with Kone Elevator India Private Limited, has restored the Keezhkattalai lake and also developed an eco-park. The lake, located along Pallavaram-Thoraipakkam 200-Foot Radial Road, was handed over to the Tambaram City Municipal Corporation recently.

The lake and its area were cleaned of trash, and a de-weeding exercise was conducted, along with jungle clearance along the lake. This was followed by dredging and de-silting work and strengthening of the bunds.

After the lake was restored, 600 tree saplings were planted along the lake, and a vetiver and palm seed plantation along the lake bund for erosion control.

The lake surroundings have been transformed into a clean, green, and vibrant eco-space, promoting ecological conservation, improving the lake's ecological



health and raising environmental awareness among citizens, said a release.

In a release, S. Senthur Pari, president, Exnora International Founda-

tion, said the project is an example of how corporate social responsibility, government support, and active community participation can work together to res-

At the inauguration of the improved Keezhkattalai lake.

PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

store nature, enrich urban biodiversity, and create healthier living spaces for future generations.

Other amenities at the lake include children's play area, fitness area, solar-powered pathway lights and aerator fountains, mild steel hand railings, paver pathways, protective fencing and pedestrian cross-over bridge, and concrete benches.

M. Veerappan, Collector, Chengalpattu district; S. Balachander, Commissioner, Tambaram City Municipal Corporation; Amit Gosain, Managing Director - India, Kone Elevator India Private Limited; M. Janaki, Chief Engineer, Water Resources Department, Chennai region, were present.

READERS WRITE

Chalk out a schedule for water supply

S. CHANDRASEKARAN

On behalf of the Chitlapakkam residents, I thank the Commissioner, officials, and the elected representatives of the Tambaram City Municipal Corporation for their efforts and follow-ups in implementing the Chembarambakkam drink-

ing water scheme in the region, supplied by the Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board.

The scheme's implementation in the region has been a long-standing demand among residents.

This will improve supply and meet residents' needs to the fullest

extent. At the same time, I appeal to the civic body to formulate a system and prepare a schedule specifying which days, wards, localities, and streets will receive water supply. It would be good if time is mentioned, too. This should be circulated to the residents to help prepare them to utilise the supply. Also, the civic body should construct tanks and sumps to increase the storage capacity and store adequate water.

S. Chandrasekaran is the secretary of The Chitlapakkam Anna Nagar Residents' Welfare Association

Bhajan session today in Chromepet

A devotional Abhang bhajan 'Harikeerthan' by Raghu-nath Dass and his team will be held on August 9 at 3 p.m. at Chromepet Cultural Academy, Indira Gandhi Cross Street, off Radha Nagar Main Road, Radha Nagar.

For details, call G. Nagara-jan, the academy's secretary, at 9444690174, 7338833944.

The clickety clack continues



LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

A chorus of clickety-clacks from manual typewriters drowns the bustle on Jagannathapuram First Street, which sits in a tract of Chetpet where every house leans into the next somewhat like books in a library shelf. Inside, as young fingers dance over ageing manual typewriters, kept sprightly by consistent maintenance, teacher-plus-owner of Chetpet Typewriting Institute (est. 1975) P. Padmanabhan is supervising yet another class, spelling out instructions to students.

Typing proficiency opening doors to certain clerical positions in government and private settings, being an essential component in certain competitive government exams including TNPSC Group IV, certain categories of Staff Selection Commission, institutes of this nature still thrive. Padmanabhan points out every class includes students who see typing skill as an end in itself. Therefore, also expect those training for careers in law, the corporate world and so on to walk in through those doors.

And these multiple needs keep these instruments going, refur-



P. Padmanabhan at Chetpet Typewriting Institute; and (below) typewriter mechanic S. Thyagarajan.

2006, taking the mantle from his father and running Chetpet Typewriting Institute. The institute operating from a space in Padmanabhan's house, makes the overheads of running it manageable. He notes with quiet pride, "I am a certified high-speed typewriting expert and an official government examiner," recognised by the Ta-

bished from time to time. Chetpet Typewriting Institute is not the oldest, but is symbolic of typewriting institutes continuing despite challenges from technology.

Padmanabhan belabours typewriting institutes' continuing relevance, citing numbers and benefits. "There are 4,200 government-approved typewriting institutes across Tamil Nadu," he states. "Typewriting equips a person to type faster and more efficiently. Once you master it, operating a computer becomes effortless."

This belief has had Padmanabhan, now aged 75, wearing a new hat post his retirement as medical photo officer (also known as 'medical photographer') from Rajiv Gandhi Government Hospital in

mil Nadu Directorate of Technical Education (DoTE). With 50 students at present, Padmanabhan personally teaches both Tamil and English typewriting; shorthand classes are also offered. His voice resonating with justifiable pride, he says: "Search my name online, you will find it."

Certainly, decades ago, every street probably sported a typewriting institute. Those like Padmanabhan maintain their numbers would have dwindled, but their relevance has not been eroded. And this is why, 20 years after retirement, he continues to fill his house with a chorus of clickety-clacks.

'Rescuing' typewriters

The phone rings, and within minutes, 54-year-old S. Thyagarajan is on his way to 'rescue' another manual typewriter. There is no workshop, no colourful signboards announcing his trade. He is the workshop on the move; and his experience repairing manual

typewriters since 1986 is the signboard. Owners of typewriting institutes across Chennai have his number saved as "ICE". That is obviously hyperbole, but typewriter mechanics such as Thyagarajan are indeed indispensable in "emergency" situations involving these machines, as brands selling manual typewriters have long ceased production, and the old machines have to be kept in circulation. Thyagarajan entered the profession soon after completing Class 10, having been born into a family of typewriter mechanics, his grandfather and uncle particularly known in the trade. The clatter of these machines defines his earliest memories, and he is among a dedicated group of people who refuse to let manual typewriters become a memory. While typewriter manufacturers have ceased production, he says typewriters are far from extinction. "The spare parts still come from Delhi. A manufacturer who started the business when typewriters were in their heyday continues to supply them to this day," he explains.

He notes that around 40 regular customers, including several typewriting institutes still rely on his services. Thyagarajan once ran repair shops which he shut down as rents escalated. "Every occupation evolves with time. One phone is enough now to run your business," he says.

He is a staunch believer not only in these machines, but also what they bring to the table, well sheet. He is emphatic those trained on typewriters make fewer mistakes because their fingers develop greater typing accuracy than those who learn typing directly on computer keyboards, particularly while typing Indian languages such as Tamil. "Even my name has been misspelt umpteen number of times," he remarks bitterly, adding that such mistakes can create unnecessary complications in government records. And for that reason and also for the fact that livelihoods still depend on typewriting institutes, he wants these old machines to continue clicking away in classrooms and examination halls.

A plea to the Tamil Nadu government

Typewriting institutes are anxious over a government order dated October 28, 2024 stating that the Department of Technical Education (DoTE) in Tamil Nadu would be doing away with the practice of having typing exams on manual typewriters, shifting them to computers from February 2028. Echoing the collective sentiment of associations representing typewriting institutes across the state, J. Srinivasan of Karumari Technical Institute in Saidapet, told The Hindu Downtown that typewriting exams in English and Tamil should be conducted only on typewriters. He points out, "Besides, the Computer on Office Automation (COA) exam should not be merged with the English and Tamil typewriting exams. Instead, the current system of conducting the three exams separately with a separate certificate given for each should continue. Every year, more than one lakh students take typing exams, conducted every six months. Clubbing them with COA will reduce the number of takers; and that will result in reduced revenue for the government." Srinivasan adds that switching typing exams from manual typewriters to computers will affect the livelihoods of typewriting institutes and typewriter mechanics across Tamil Nadu, which he estimates around 5000 and 2000 respectively. He states: "Associations and federations representing these institutes and mechanics want this GO cancelled."

A Fight For Survival
In the run-up to Madras Day, a look at an old industry that is pitted against new technology

Here are voices from the city that assert that though typewriting institutes have steadily dwindled in numbers since Madras became Chennai, the manual typewriter still deserves a place under the sun, alongside the computer



ERR

In focus: Elevator Safety 101

If the lift in your apartment gets stuck often, it is time to check when its license was last renewed

LIFFY THOMAS

In the last one year, how many times have you or a family member got stranded in a lift in your residential building?

Of the 1,540 responses from Chennai residents that LocalCircles received to this question, 48% said they were fortunate not to get stuck; 25% were unfortunate to have that unsavoury experience once or twice.

Just like elevators in public spaces and mass transit facilities such as MRTS stations, those at apartment communities can show their malfunctioning machine side, frustrating residents. When an elevator malfunctions in any setting, private or public, and causes a safety threat to users, who are the entities one pins the blame on?

Going by a recent Supreme Court ruling, the ma-

nufacturer, the maintenance agency and the owner of the premises are jointly liable for any breach of the safety of lift users.

A pan-India study by community social media platform LocalCircles found 33% had no confidence in the safety of lifts installed in their building. Close to 32% of the respondents from Chennai said the lift in their community was maintained by the lift manufacturer via annual maintenance contract (AMC); another 37% said lifts were maintained by a third party via AMC; 20% said no regular maintenance, only repairs based on issues.

Although the Tamil Nadu Lift Rules

Act, 1997 got amended this year, accountability is still raised only after a lift malfunctions or an accident happens. Many lifts continue to function without license renewal.

Challenges to inspection

In fact, identifying lifts functioning without a valid licence is a big challenge faced by the Electrical Inspectorate, a department under the Government of Tamil Nadu. Besides other functions, the department is responsible for issuing of permission for lifts and escalators to be installed and for the renewal of licenses.

As per the Tamil Nadu Lifts and Escalators (Amendment) Act, 2025, which came into effect in February 2026, license for lifts has to be renewed once in five years.

V. Ramakrishnan, chief electrical inspector to the State Government, says they previously used to send reminders to buildings for renewal, but now that the process is "auto generated" they stopped.

Renewal process

can be done online and must be initiated three months before it expires. The average fee for renewal and penalty for late payment is a small sum, a reason why many buildings ignore it.

The renewal process is important to identify defects and take up preventive steps before a compliance report is submitted

"It is not possible to keep inspecting buildings that have not renewed their licence as there are hundreds of buildings with this facility, but based on complaints we do random checks," says Ramakrishnan, adding that the public can bring it to the department's notice.

Recently, when passengers were trapped in a lift at Puzhuthivakkam MRTS station, the department sent out its team to inspect it.

Besides shortage in manpower, the Department is often faced with issues among residents in apartment associations who derail the process for renewal.

The official says that very recently at an apartment in Chennai the secretary of the association had applied for renewal but the president called to complain that the exercise was taken up without approval of a majority of residents.

"In apartments, there is conflict among residents as those on the ground floor do not want to pay for lift charges and renewal, so we are asked to intervene," he says.

For complaints and other issues, email ceig@tn.gov.in and ceig@tn.nic.in



Paying a premium to ensure safe lifts

This gated community in Manapakkam allocates a huge sum every year for the maintenance of its elevators

Casagrand Irene, a gated community in Manapakkam with 295 flats spread across 15 blocks and 13 villas, has ensured lift-related complaints are kept to a minimum by paying a premium for the maintenance of lifts.

"We spend 4-5 percent of our total revenue in lift maintenance, which translates to around ₹ 10.5 lakh annually," says Lebbaeus Denis, secretary, Casagrand Irene Owners Welfare Association.

Under a contract with Schneider Electricals, the Association has signed up for Diamond Category Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC), which is the highest in the plan, gold and silver being the other two categories.

In the diamond category, all spare parts including battery

come under unlimited warranty. Every year, the company also undertakes a pre-maintenance schedule in which they replace most of the parts in the functioning of the lift. Besides, what is mandated by the manufacturer, once in every two years the Association replaces the batteries as well, especially in blocks where lifts see more wear and tear.

"There are two batteries in one lift, each costing ₹13,000. The life a battery lasts three years but as a precautionary measure we schedule the replacement a little before the cut-off time," says Denis.

Besides checks every month, the community just needs to raise a complaint in a software and in three hours the technical team arrives to fix the issue.

As in many communities where owners of flats on the ground floor complain about paying for an amenity they rarely use, this community has faced this situation. With villas also dotting the community, they have a big voice against spiralling bills on lift maintenance.

Denis feels that expenditure will keep coming but Associations need to find alternative revenue streams. "We have allotted space for digital ads kept outside the lift that give us ₹ 6 lakh revenue a year, this way we are incurring a more manageable expense on lift maintenance and at the same time ensuring residents have little to complain about," says the secretary.



SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

When conversations around screen addiction come up, they almost always centre on children and teenagers. But what about the adults who spend their workdays peering into laptops, unwind by scrolling through social media, and end the day glued to the television screen?

Here is the outline of an answer to that. And it is being sketched by The Kraft Faktor, a small-batch handmade products brand, creating soaps, shampoos, perfumes, candles and home fragrances, that has over time tucked an experience-based initiative into the shopping bag, conducting craft-based workshops, curating personalised gifts and developing DIY kits for people to continue crafting at home.

Deepa Sam and Nabeela Rehman, founders of The Kraft Faktor (TKF), view digital overload as cutting across demographic divides. TKF has inked in a couple of small-batch workshops (Mindful Line Art & Pattern Making and Paper Alchemy - Beginner-friendly Decoupage) for August 15 (11 a.m. to 1 p.m.) at Playbae Cafe in Thoraipakkam that indirectly address screen addiction. For participation, the number of birthdays someone has had so far carries little weight. For additional details about the workshop, DM them on Insta @thekraftfaktor.

These workshops have a philosophical underpinning, simple but far-reaching.

"We are saying: consciously build a habit in your 20s and 30s of practising some form of art or craft every day," says Deepa. "It could be anything. It could simply be cooking a meal or consciously grooming yourself. If these small routines are done consciously, the results are not visible in one or two days, but over time they make a difference."

Participants of TKF's workshops range from young professionals looking for a break from busy work schedules to retirees trying to fill the void that often follows decades of routine. "We noticed that this stage of life often leaves a huge vacuum," says Deepa. "Many people naturally fall into digital consumption."

For the founders, the concern is not simply the amount of time

Screen addiction is disproportionately associated with children and teenagers, adults often being a glaring omission. In Chennai on August 15, two workshops seek to wean grown-ups off screens by teaching them a craft

Screen time off for seniors too



people spend online. It is the way screens constantly compete for attention. "For me, it is very simply put – overstimulation versus correct stimulation," Deepa says. "On a screen there are hundreds of images and notifications. Even if you are only watching a few posts or one reel, you generally do not stop because social media is designed to keep you hooked."

Here is the contrast TKF seeks to drive home through its workshops.

"When you are creating a craft with your hands, your brain focuses on one task for 15-20 minutes. You are following one process, one sequence, one goal. There is also a natural stopping point. You finish one page, one piece or one step," Deepa adds.

Unlike scrolling through an endless stream of content, craft requires people to interact with real materials, making decisions, changing tack and reviewing the output. Paper has to be folded. Wax has to be poured. Glue has to be applied. Hands move objects, feel textures and respond to the material in front of them. Instead of reacting to rapidly changing colours, movement and notifications, attention stays with one activity at a time.

Nabeela elaborates: "With doomscrolling, you are only taking in information. Every second you are absorbing something new. When you are doing an activity, you are constantly asking yourself, 'What next? How can I do this? Is there a better way than last time?' There's a give-and-take in the process."

Mindfulness is a healthy by-product. Someone who makes things regularly is also more likely to think carefully about what they buy, how they use materials and whether something can be repaired, reused or repurposed instead of discarded.

The workshops themselves are intentionally small, with no more than eight participants at a time. A DIY kit is part of what every workshop offers, making it easier for participants to keep practising long after the session ends.



From a line art workshop; and the result of a decoupage exercise.

Nominate a teacher that made a difference

Mission Guru Devo Bhava, in association with the Lions Club of Meenambakkam, invites nominations for the third edition of Vidhya Seva Samman.

The initiative aims to honour teachers who have gone beyond the classroom, inspired their students, nurtured values and made a genuine difference to their lives.

Anil Kitcha, in a press note, says the initiative hopes to build a tradition through which society respectfully thanks teachers and whose influence extends far beyond the classroom and transformed the lives of their students and strengthened communities.

This year, the organisers propose to honour 10 deserving teachers from schools across Chennai. Each awardee will re-

ceive a cash award of ₹50,000, a citation and a memento.

Schools, parents, students, teachers and members of the public can nominate a teacher that truly deserves a recognition.

The late date to nominate in August 15, 2026. The awards will be presented on September 6, 2026 at the DAV Girls Senior Secondary School auditorium, Gopalapuram.

For details, visit tinyurl.com/vssteachernomination



RMKV's new collection inspired by Japanese culture

RMKV Silks, known for its wedding silks and silk saris, has launched a range of exclusive handwoven silks inspired by Japanese heritage and culture, 'Kumo Korvai', 'Mt Fuji', and 'Sashiko Reversible'.

The silks, known for their pioneering designs and advanced weaving techniques, have earned the brand two national awards, a Guinness World Record, and sev-

eral patents, according to a release from the enterprise.

The store has partnered with the Central Silk Board to develop a modernised pneumatic handloom, an innovation designed to reduce the physical strain of weaving while enabling artisans to better use their skills and enhance productivity. By making the weaving process less labour-intensive, the initiative has also

encouraged greater participation of women in the craft, creating new opportunities while preserving the essence of traditional handloom weaving, the release added.

The store is renowned for its naturally dyed silk saris and patented 40 percent lighter 'Lino' silk saris, the grand reversible sari, and the world's longest theme-silk sari, the release said.

Bring your old zari sari to Rasi Silks

Rasi Silks (Radha Silk Emporium), which was established in 1900, offers a comprehensive shopping experience for the entire family. Its portal <https://rasisilks.com> displays a magnificent collection from signature Kancheepuram pure silk saris to lightweight cottons, Pochampally and Banaras weaves, said a release.

The portal also features a dedicated, premium

segment of ethnic wear for men, designed for weddings, festivals and formal gatherings. The classic men's kurta is meticulously tailored from pure silk and fine cotton, featuring both subtle, minimalist designs and intricate traditional motifs.

The portal is secure for online payments, added the release. The Mylapore-based outlet is having an old sari exchange initiative. Customers can bring in their heirloom, old pure zari saris for evaluation, and upgrade their wardrobes with stunning new drapes.

Essay competition on eye donation

In observance of National Eye Donation Fortnight, TwinTech Healthcare Services, a unit of the TwinTech Institute of Education Trust is conducting an essay competition on the theme "Donate Eyes, Gift Sight, and Give Life." The competition is open to all.

The essay can be in English or

Tamil not exceeding 1,500 words, highlighting the importance of eye donation, its impact on individuals and society, and innovative ways to motivate people to pledge their eyes.

Details about the participant such as full name, age, complete postal address, along with a brief profile should be mentioned.

Participants are expected to submit original essays and AI-generated entries will be disqualified

without any notice, says a press release. The initiative aims to spread awareness about the importance of eye donation.

The last date for submission of the essay is August 15 by 5 p.m. to the following email: chennai.twintech@gmail.com

The winners will be announced on August 20.

For details, participants may contact Dr. A. Mahalingam through WhatsApp: 97104 85295.

Workshops at Guindy

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Chennai along with Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Ahmedabad is offering a one-year certificate course on Entrepreneurship & Innovation. Classes for this will start this month. Graduates aged between 21 and 40 years can apply. Applications can be downloaded from the following link: <https://editn.in/Web-One-Year-Registration>

For details, call 8668101638 / 8668107552.

Other workshops Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute - Chennai are conducting are E-Commerce from August 19 to 21; creation of YouTube channel from August 12 to 14; Training in gold appraisal from August 17 to 21. For details, call 8668100181 / 9360221280

Temporary changes in train services

The Chennai Division of Southern Railway is undertaking a comprehensive redevelopment of Chennai Egmore Railway Station. The express trains will temporarily originate and terminate at Tambaram and Mambalam stations till 20th August.

Train No : 16866, Thanjavur - Chennai Egmore Uzhan Express to terminate at Tambaram till 19th August.

Train No : 16865, Chennai Egmore - Thanjavur Uzhan Express to originate from Tambaram till 20th August.

Train No : 20636, Kollam - Chennai Egmore Ananthapuri Express to terminate at Tambaram till 19th August.

Train No : 20635, Chennai Egmore - Kollam Ananthapuri Express to originate from Tambaram till 20th August

Train No : 16160 Mangalore - Chennai Egmore Express to terminate at Tambaram till 19th August.



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